

JULY NEWSLETTER

22 JULY 2022



Dear Families,

We are starting off the term with some positive changes and jobs completed.

The ceiling of the Dapin room has now been replaced and the whole room has had a fresh coat of paint. Their bathroom has had a full overhaul, while it may look the same, we now have a new floor and wall tiles. The toilets and hand basin were replaced and the children now have sensor taps. These taps will help to reduce the cross transmission of germs and save us water too.

While we still have a high number of COVID-19 transmission in our community we are hoping that we can continue to reopen the service to families.

We are now allowing one member of each family to come into the service at arrival and departure times. We ask that you continue to do the following to help reduce any transmission within the service:

- Organise your drop off and pick up so that you don't need to bring primary aged children onto the premises. If this is not possible, we ask if they wait outside, sitting on the garden retaining wall.
- If you have any flu symptoms, please wear a mask while on our premises.
- If you or any other member of your household has COVID or Influenza (flu) we strongly request that you keep your child at home even if they don't have any signs or symptoms.
- Continue to use the hand sanitiser before entering the service.
- Check your child's message file for art work, communication letters, lost personal items, etc.

LAND PURCHASE

The service is delighted to announce the purchase of an additional block of land, 56 Hume St. There are many opportunities for developing our service here and the committee is currently working through all the possibilities. It is a great asset for the service and the wider community for funds to be continually reinvested back into community projects.

ARRIVAL & DEPARTURE PROCEDURES

We ask that families make sure that they have let an educator know that they have arrived or are leaving with their child. This ensures we know where children are at all times and support their safety and wellbeing. If the preschool children are in the outdoor learning area, please spend the time to come downstairs to help support a smooth transition of supervision and care responsibilities.

GOODBYE & THANK YOU TO VANESSA

We would like to thank Vanessa for all her work and long engagement with the service

over the past 11 years. Vanessa had her last work day with us over the school holidays and has now joined her husband in Tasmania to start their next chapter in life.

Vanessa and her family have had a lasting positive impact to the service. Not only did all her three children attend over many years. Vanessa held many roles on our Management Committee including the position of President. She resigned from this position to take on a CIII traineeship and has now completed her qualifications after working both in the Supported Mobile Playgroup and in the Early Years Learning Centre.

We wish her and her family all the best with their new life in Tassie.



PLAYGROUP DATES

Booral...Tues 26 Jul
Gloucester CWA...Tues 2 Aug
Coolongolook...Wed 3 Aug
Booral...Tues 9 Aug
Gloucester CWA...Tues 16 Aug
Coolongolook...Wed 17 Aug
Booral...Tues 23 Aug
Gloucester CWA...Tues 6 Sep
Coolongolook...Wed 7 Sep
Booral...Tues 13 Sep
Gloucester CWA...Tues 20 Sep
Coolongolook...Wed 21 Sep

DATES TO REMEMBER

- **Committee Meeting—**
Thursday 28th July at 6pm

EQUIPMENT PURCHASES

Australian Animal Figure Play Sets
x2



POLICIES REVIEW IN JUNE

- ◆ Coronavirus Policy & Risk Assessment
- ◆ Administration of Authorised Medication Policy
- ◆ Infectious Diseases Policy
- ◆ Privacy and Confidentiality Policy
- ◆ Staffing Arrangements Policy
- ◆ Unenrolled Children Policy
- ◆ Conflict of Interest Policy
- ◆ Asset Policy

ABSENCES

Please let the service know if your child is going to be away for the day. It helps with the daily management of the classrooms and allows families who require an additional day to book in and utilise the vacancy.

MID-YEAR CHILDREN'S LETTERS

Each year the teachers write a mid-year letter to each child. These letters are now in your child's journal. The letters highlight your child's interests, progress and achievements over the first half of the year. We would love for families to take their child's journal home and read the letter to your child. You can also write your own letter to your child or their teacher in response to this letter and add it to your child's journal.

If you have any questions you can discuss your child's progress over the phone or via an organised appointment time with their teacher throughout the Term.

SCHOOL PHOTOS

School photos are booked in for Tuesday 9th August to Monday 15th August. We are using a new company this year. All children will be photographed and booking forms will be available direct from their website. See flyer on the back page of the newsletter.

BREAD BAGS

Just a reminder that we collect your used plastic bread bags within the service. Please collect them and give them to a staff member or put in the nappy change area of the babies and toddlers room. These are used for bagging up soiled nappies and help us reduce our purchasing of single use plastic.

EMPLOYING NEW STAFF

Our service is looking to employ new educators. If you or someone you know are interested in a career in the Early Childhood Education & Care, please see Kareen or Elizabeth. We can offer Certificate III traineeships, or employment full time or part time for those who have already completed the relevant CIII or Diploma qualification.

CELEBRATING 50 YEARS OF GLOUCESTER PRE SCHOOL

Gloucester Pre School was officially opened on the 27th October 1972. To celebrate this significant milestone the committee is organising an open day and official function. If you have any photos, stories or links to the organisation we would love to hear from you. More information will be coming out soon but in the mean time you can send any information to Robyn at:

accounts@gloucesterpreschool.com.au

VACATION CARE

In the first week of vacation care, the children participated in a variety of engaging activities such as eating bush tucker outdoors, celebrating NAIDOC week and creating art with natural materials. We also cuddled up in our pyjamas for a movie day and we even made snow for winter wonderland! In week two, we explored different textures through sensory activities, we got physical at the public school playground, we threw discus and jumped hurdles. We also made our own mini pizzas and we finished it all off with a day of crazy dancing!



BANGGU ROOM NEWS

The children in the Banggu room have shown a great deal of interest in animals and the sounds they make. We have been exploring this interest using technology, music, books, puzzles and creating a farm table within the room. The children have enjoyed sharing their knowledge of the different animal sounds they know and share their enthusiasm and curiosity in learning new information. We would love if you could share with us any animal experiences your children are engaged with at home or any photographs of your children's pets so we can include them into our program, we cant wait see them.

From the Banggu team—Kayla, Tyler, Kareen and Dom



YAPII ROOM NEWS

It is great to see families being able to come back into the classroom and see our play and learning spaces.

With all the children so settled in their environment we have been focusing on supporting them in developing their independence and contributing to daily responsibilities like putting their bags away in the morning with their name card, setting the tables for lunch, self-serving at mealtimes and looking after their own belongings.

The children have shown a growing interest in farm animals through the story 'I went walking' and also making our own additions to the story and also singing 'Old MacDonald'. We are starting a project book to follow and extend on this interest this term. If you would like to send a photo of your animals at home, we can add them to our project book and interest areas. It would be great to have family input into our learning.

We have had a lot of friends move into the preschool rooms recently so we would like to say hello to them from the Yapii room and it's always nice seeing your smiling faces on the veranda throughout the day.

Please remember to keep us updated with changes to your children's routines so that we are consistently supporting your child's development.

From the Yapii Team—Kathryn, Lucy & Kareen



THE CUPBOARD OF SHARED HAPPINESS IS BACK IN FULL OPERATION

Donate what you can. Take what you need. Neighbour helping neighbour, building stronger, more sustainable and caring communities.

We would be grateful for...



1. Donations of pantry goods, tinned foods, long life milk, sanitary items, toiletries, toilet paper, etc
2. Contributions to a sharing basket of home grown fresh produce, for any excess from your home gardens.
3. Donations to a themed crate. Each month we will have different items for sharing. We are looking for suggestions. This month's theme is "Canned Goods".

PLEASE CHECK THE FRIDGE FOR THE DONATED FOOD ITEMS



Please Recycle your clean soft plastics. There is a drop-off point at Woolworths. For more information, see the Redcycle Website: <https://redcycle.net.au>

Please Recycle your printer Ink Cartridges. There is a drop-off point at the Gloucester Visitor Information Centre.

DAPIN ROOM NEWS

Our classroom project on 'Healthy Lifestyles, caring for others' has been very exciting. The children delivered their care packages to letterboxes around preschool and we have had an amazing community response in return. The recipients of these packs have expressed their delight in finding their packages in the letter boxes with one of our neighbours paying the kindness back to the children by writing them letters of reply and even including surprises of their own for the children. We have received bags of oranges and mandarins that the children shared, colouring pages, letters of gratitude and drawings that their recipient drew for them. Each time a returned letter came in for the children, we grouped together on the mat so we could all share in the opening of the letters and listen to the kind words. What has made me feel the proudest is that the children have not expected anything in return. They all posted their mail to their selected letter box and all shared in the excitement of getting letters in reply. The Gloucester advocate is interested in covering this good news story so keep an eye out for that as well.



On Friday we walked down to Gloucester Community Garden where Pippa and other members of the gardening group showed us around the gardens and taught us some more about caring for a worm farm, composting, and growing food. They even let us try mandarins that they grew! We would love to do more visits like this to deepen the children's gardening knowledge from this group of people who have so much gardening knowledge to share.



Thankyou to those families who have supplied photos of your children as babies already. We would love to receive one for every child please.

From the Dapin team: Jenny, Jacklyn and Jed



GAWUL ROOM NEWS

The Gawul room had a great start to Term Three as we are adapting some positive changes in our daily practices. We are focusing on 'Sustainability' this term and incorporating it in our routine. We are maintaining hygiene through our regular hand washing routine and learning about how to reduce the usage of our resources such as water, soap and washcloths. In our art area, we are reducing the use of paper and using more natural materials, like barks, leaves and twigs. The children have been enthusiastically learning about how our everyday actions can make a difference in saving our planet. We will continue to investigate and explore different methods to practice sustainability. Thank you to all the parents for supporting our positive changes. We welcome your suggestions.

From the Gawul team—Sharon, Rashelle and Olivia



Ultra-Satisfying Chicken Noodle Soup –Makes 6 servings

(AUTHOR:Adam and Joanne Gallagher)

Ingredients:	Method:	Tips
◆ 2 tablespoons butter, chicken fat or olive oil ◆ 1 large onion, chopped ◆ 2 large carrots, chopped ◆ 2 stalks celery, chopped (optional) ◆ Heaped tablespoon minced garlic (4 cloves) ◆ 2 bay leaves ◆ 3 sprigs fresh thyme or use 1/2 teaspoon dried thyme ◆ 1 pound skinless, boneless chicken thighs (4 or 5 thighs) ◆ 8 cups chicken stock or broth, low sodium or use homemade stock ◆ 5 ounces egg noodles (or pasta of choice) ◆ Salt and pepper, to taste ◆ 1/4 cup fresh parsley, finely chopped PREP 5min COOK 35min	1. Melt butter in a large pot or Dutch oven over medium heat. Add the onions, carrots, and celery. Cook, stirring every few minutes until the vegetables begin to soften; 5 to 6 minutes. 2. Stir in the garlic, bay leaves, and thyme. Cook, while stirring the garlic around the pan, for about 1 minute. 3. Pour in the chicken stock and bring to a low simmer. Taste the soup then adjust the seasoning with salt and pepper. Depending on the stock used, you might need to add 1 or more teaspoons of salt. 4. Submerge the chicken thighs into the soup so that the broth covers them. Bring the soup back to a low simmer then partially cover the pot with a lid and cook, stirring a few times until the chicken thighs are cooked through; about 20 minutes. 5. If, during this time, the broth seems low, add a splash more stock or a bit of water. Turn the heat to medium-low. 6. Transfer the cooked chicken to a plate. Stir the noodles into the soup and cook until done, 6 to 10 minutes depending on the type of noodles used. 7. While the noodles cook, shred the chicken into strips or dice into cubes. Slide the chicken back into the pot and then taste the soup once more for seasoning. Adjust with more salt and pepper, as needed. Stir in the parsley and serve. 	This quicker version of homemade chicken noodle soup skips cooking a whole chicken and calls on boneless, skinless chicken thighs instead. The soup still tastes incredible, satisfying, and classic. The significantly reduced cook time makes this chicken soup from scratch possible on a weeknight. We highly recommend chicken thighs for this because of their flavor and soft texture when cooked, but if you prefer them, chicken breasts will work. Refrigerating Chicken Noodle Soup: As the soup sits, the noodles soak up the soup broth. When reheating, add a splash of extra chicken stock or if you don't have any, water. Freezing Chicken Noodle Soup: The noodles don't fare too well when frozen. If you plan on freezing the soup, remove the portion of soup you plan to freeze before adding the noodles. Freeze the broth, chicken, and vegetables. When you are ready to reheat the soup, add dried noodles to the soup and simmer until done. Seasoning the Soup: If you feel the soup is missing some zing, add a bit more salt. You can also add a pop of flavor with a squeeze of fresh lemon juice, a dash of fish sauce (we use this trick for store-bought stocks and broths often) or Worcestershire sauce.



REMEMBER THIS PHOTOGRAPHY

Gloucester Preschool Annual Centre Photos 2022

Tues 9th, Wed 10th, Thurs 11th, Fri 12th & Mon 15th August

Casey will be visiting your center in August to capture your annual preschool photos. There is no need to pre-order, all children will be photographed and your online gallery and ordering instructions will be provided to you in the 2 weeks following photo day.

A few things to note:

- *You are able to view your photos before you place your order*
- *Siblings attending the centre will be photographed together also and sibling galleries will be combined*
- *Online galleries are private and password protected, only available to you*
- *As I'll be attending your center over five days there will be five group photos taken. If your child attends each day you will have the option of which group photo you wish to purchase, or you may purchase more than one*
- *If your child is unable to attend on their scheduled day, you are most welcome to bring them in any day to be photographed. The group photos will be taking place at 10am each day.*

More questions? Feel free to email Casey at rememberthisphoto@live.com.au

